

CyLab Redaction Gone Wrong Writeup

Challenge Overview

Event: PicoCTF 2022

Challenge Name: Redaction gone wrong

Category: Forensics

Difficulty: Medium

Points: 100

Challenge Description

This [report](#) (Financial Report for ABC Labs, Kigali, Rwanda for the year 2021) has some critical data in it, some of which have been redacted correctly, while some were not. Can you find an important key that was not redacted properly?

Hint: How can you be sure of the redaction?

Step 1: Viewing the File

Download the report to see what has been redacted. When viewing the pdf, you will see that certain parts of the pdf have been redacted.

Financial Report for ABC Labs, Kigali, Rwanda for the year 2021.

██████████ - Just painted over in MS word.

11/11/2019

Cost Benefit Analysis

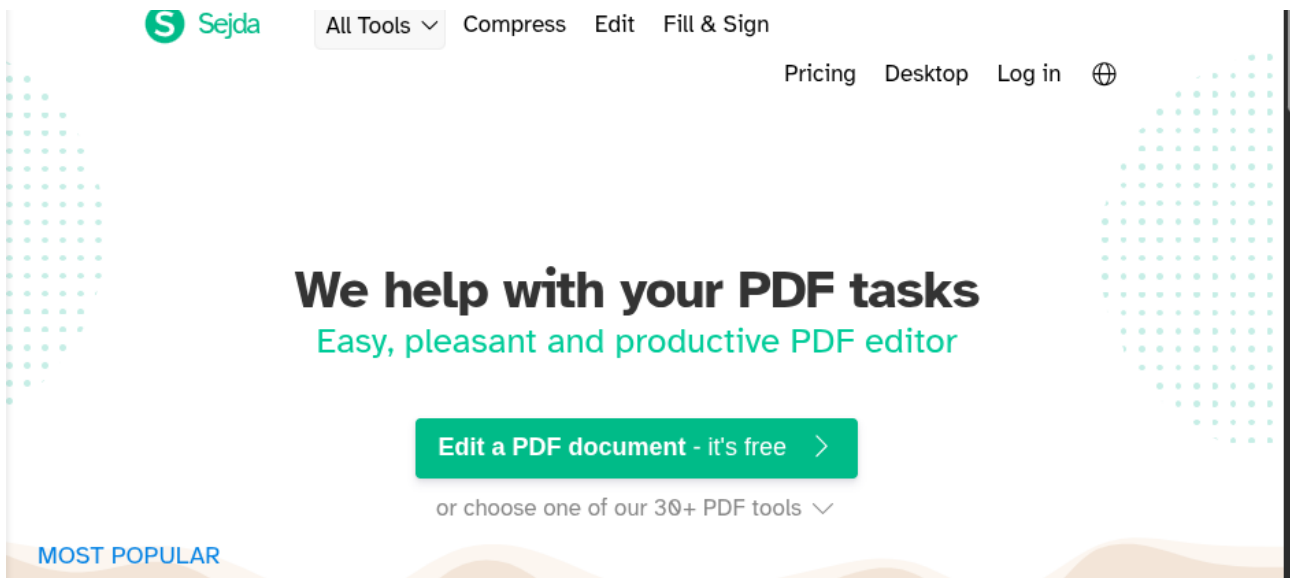
	Credit	Debit
1. Cash		100
2. Accounts Receivable		100
3. Inventory		100
4. Prepaid Expenses		100
5. Equipment		100
6. Accumulated Depreciation		
7. Accounts Payable	100	
8. Notes Payable	100	
9. Long-Term Debt	100	
10. Equity	100	
Total	300	300

Expenses from the [REDACTED]

Redacted document.

Step 2: Discovering the tool that will Allow You to View the Redacted Information

To solve this challenge you are going to need a tool that can edit and view redacted information within a pdf. This website <https://www.sejda.com/> is the perfect tool for this challenge. Sejda is free, so there is no need to create an account which is another reason why this tool is excellent.

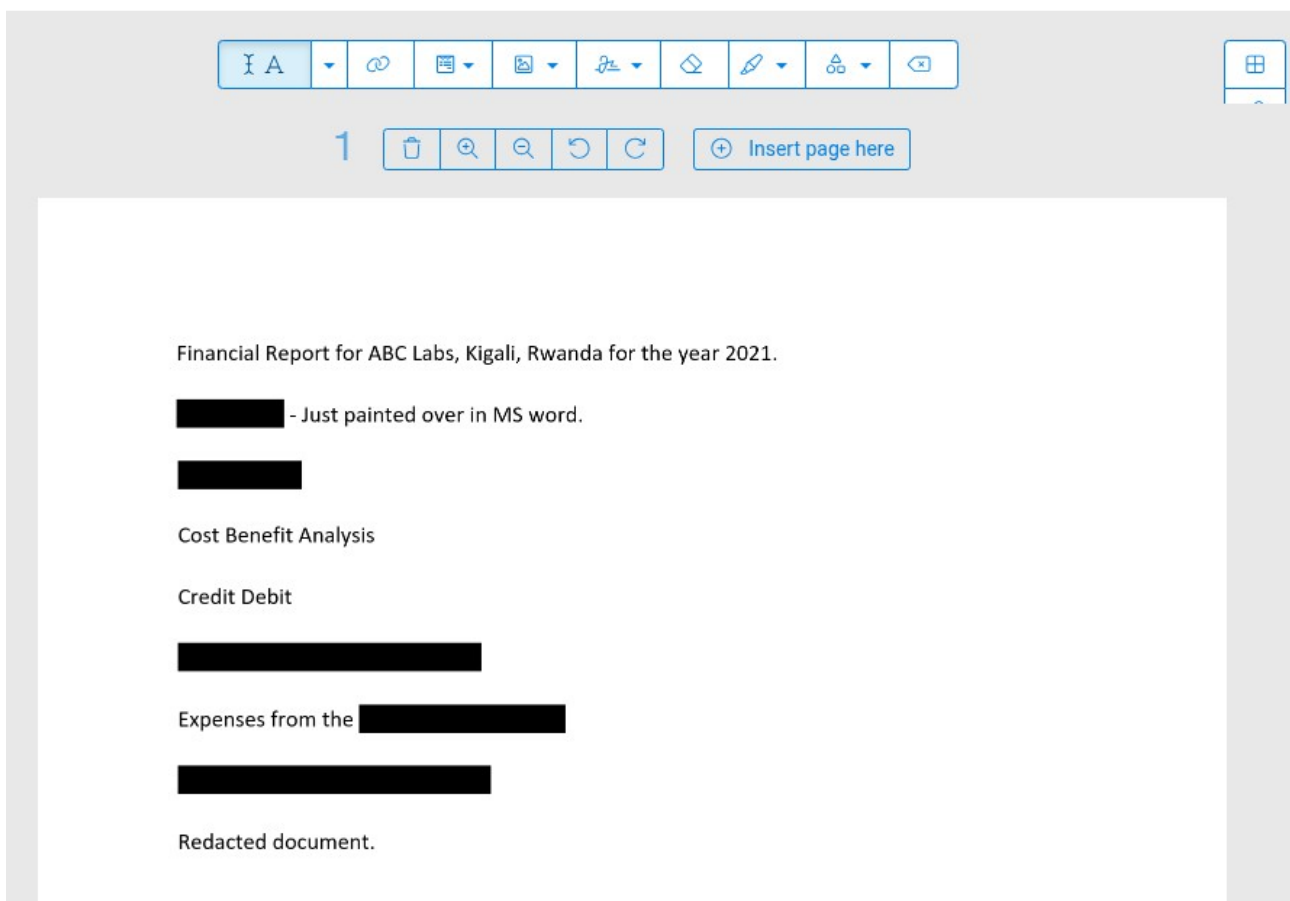


Step 3: Upload the Document

Click on the Edit a PDF document tab to upload your document. Once uploaded you can view your document and start editing.

Online PDF editor ^{BETA}

Edit PDF files for free. Fill & sign PDF



Step 4: Make the Edits

Can you guess what makes Sejda an excellent tool for this challenge? Once you have uploaded the document just click on the areas that have been redacted and the wording will appear. Note this

works on most of the blocks but not all of them. Luckily for us this technique works on the redacted information we need for this challenge. Flag has been redacted in the screenshot below.

Financial Report for ABC Labs, Kigali, Rwanda for the year 2021.

Breakdown-Just painted over in MS word.

 your text

Cost Benefit Analysis

Credit Debit

This is not the flag, keep looking



Redacted document.

Closing Thoughts

In conclusion, the Redaction gone wrong challenge was overall an easy challenge to solve and I can see why it was worth only 100 points. Once you discover the proper pdf editor the challenge is easy to solve from here. However, this challenge is valuable in sharpening your Cybersecurity skill-set. Having to view redacted information in documents is a situation you can find yourself in. Specifically, if you are conducting digital forensics for a company. What did you think of this challenge. What are other pdf editors or other ways you could solve this challenge?

Securing the digital realm one computer at a time.

Best Regards,

Dylan